



Establishing a Culture

Bringing a positive attitude and approach to your business right from the start will help motivate you and your staff. A shared culture will shape the personality of your business and how it operates.

Deciding on your values

The term “business culture” describes the approach and style of your business—it is how you and your staff operate on a daily basis. Cultures develop and evolve over time, although you can establish

a set of values that reflect what you want the business to achieve from the beginning. You cannot dictate a culture—the people working for the business bring it to life. However, you may want to initiate a process that involves your

staff and others connected to the business, including advisors or investors, to agree on a set of core values that are right for you.

Choose simple, meaningful values (see pp.24–25), such as honesty and accountability,

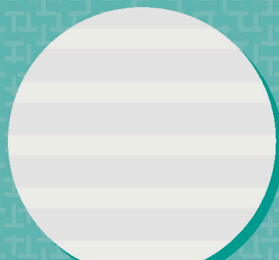
Creating the culture

Start to shape a successful culture by leading all staff and others involved in the business in a simple shared process to define meaningful values.



Get people talking

Find out what matters to individuals. Look at how other businesses have expressed their values and consider what works well and what does not.



Capture ideas and discuss

No idea is a bad one. Write down all the ideas about positive values. Explore the values and how they might relate to your business.



Organize and rationalize ideas

Group values together. Rank them according to how much difference they could make to the business. Combine similar values together until you have around 10 in all.